August 18, 2025

Jennifer Thornton
General Counsel
Office of the U.S. Trade Representative
600 17th Street, NW
Washington, DC 20508

Docket No. USTR-2025-0044 for "Request to Appear at the Hearing on the Section 301 Investigation of Act, Policies, and Practices of Brazil Related to Digital Trade and Electronic Payment Services; Unfair, Preferential Tariffs; Anti-Corruption Enforcement; Intellectual Property Protection; Ethanol Market Access; and Illegal Deforestation."

Dear Ms. Thornton,

On behalf of the National Coffee Association of USA (NCA), I request to appear at the September 3, 2025 public hearing of the Section 301 Committee at USTR.

Summary of Testimony

The National Coffee Association of USA (NCA) represents the entire U.S. coffee value chain, comprising more than 200 members who operate in every U.S. state and territory and range from major consumer brands to coffee importers, exporters, traders, brokers, roasters, retailers, and allied organizations.

The United States cannot grow coffee domestically, except for a small amount of coffee that can be grown in Hawaii and Puerto Rico. As a result, the United States must import over 99% of the coffee Americans consume in the form of unroasted coffee beans (known as "green" coffee), roasted coffee, decaffeinated coffee, and instant coffee.

Historically, coffee imports in all these categories have entered the United States duty-free. After the raw commodity arrives in the United States coffee beans are stored, cleaned, shipped, roasted, packed, marketed, prepared, and sold, supporting more than 2.2 million U.S. jobs and contributing more than $343 billion to the U.S. economy through investments, distribution, retail, and marketing activities. This value-add would be at risk due to high tariffs on Brazilian coffee imports.

Brazil is the largest coffee producer in the world by far. Per USDA's biannual report on world coffee markets and trade, Brazil produced 64.7 million bags of coffee in 2024/2025, more than 37% of global coffee produced, and over twice as much as the second largest coffee supplier (Vietnam - 16.6%) and more coffee than the combined total of the next four largest producers (Vietnam, Colombia, Ethiopia and Indonesia).

The United States coffee industry and the two-thirds of American adults who drink coffee each day depend on coffee imports from Brazil. In 2024, the United States imported over $9.8 billion of coffee with Brazil providing over 20% of total coffee imports, including green coffee, roasted, decaf, and soluble coffee. About 30%-40% of all green coffee imported into the United States is from Brazil. However, coffee accounts for only about 5% of Brazil's exports to the United States in 2024.

With significant U.S. tariffs on green coffee from Brazil, U.S. roasters of coffee will be severely disadvantaged. Imports of coffee from Brazil cannot be easily substituted, if at all, since Brazil is by far the largest coffee producer globally.

Brazilian suppliers could easily pivot to providing green coffee beans to roasters in China, the European Union, Switzerland, Canada, and Mexico, potentially undermining this important value-added food processing sector in the United States and harming the 2.2 million jobs that rely on it.

For these reasons, we strongly urge the administration to not include coffee in any proposed tariffs or trade restrictions under the Section 301 review, given the absence of domestic alternatives to coffee imports and the devastating impact coffee tariffs would have on U.S. coffee drinkers, U.S. coffee workers, and the U.S. economy, and remove tariffs on imports of all Brazilian coffee imported under HTS 0901, 2101.11, and 2102.12.

Sincerely,

William M. Murray

William (Bill) Murray
President & CEO
National Coffee Association of USA